

ROTTON FENCEPOST FIELD GUIDE

A Simple System for Finding Hidden Causes That Keep Life Repeating Problems

By Kahu Phil Stephens

Ke Aupuni O Ke Akua Press

WHY THIS EXISTS

Most people spend their lives trying to fix visible problems.

But the real issue is often hidden.

A fence doesn't fail where you see the damage.

It fails at a **post you didn't inspect**.

This guide teaches you a simple way to stop treating symptoms and start identifying causes.

Not theory.

Not philosophy.

A practical way to see what you've been missing.

THE PRINCIPLE

Rotten Fencepost Principle:

When something keeps repeating in your life, the cause is usually not what you can see—it is a hidden weakness underneath it.

WHAT THIS IS (AND IS NOT)

This is:

- A way to diagnose repeating problems
- A thinking system for daily life
- A tool for identifying hidden causes
- A simple inspection method

This is NOT:

- A motivational book
 - A medical or financial instruction manual
 - A quick-fix promise
 - A replacement for professional advice
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PART 1: LEARN TO SEE DIFFERENTLY

The Core Problem

Most people ask:

“How do I fix this?”

But the better question is:

“Why does this keep happening?”

Fixing symptoms gives temporary relief.

Finding causes creates permanent change.

The 3 Reasons People Miss the Real Problem

1. The symptom is louder than the cause

What hurts gets attention. What causes it stays hidden.

2. Repetition feels normal

If it keeps happening, people assume it “just is what it is.”

3. The real cause is uncomfortable to face

So the mind avoids it.

PART 2: THE 3-QUESTION INSPECTION METHOD

Whenever something repeats in your life, stop and ask:

QUESTION 1: What is repeating?

Not the event—look for the pattern.

Examples:

- Same type of relationship conflict
- Same financial cycle
- Same emotional struggle
- Same health issue returning

Write it clearly.

QUESTION 2: What am I reacting to?

Reaction hides understanding.

Ask:

- Am I responding emotionally instead of thoughtfully?
 - What triggers me most in this situation?
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QUESTION 3: What am I not seeing?

This is the “fencepost question.”

Ask:

- What have I assumed is fine without checking?
 - What have I ignored because it felt normal?
 - What underlying issue could be driving this?
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PART 3: THE FENCEPOST FRAMEWORK

Every repeated problem has two layers:

Surface Layer (Visible)

- Behavior

- Outcome
- Emotion
- Situation

Hidden Layer (Invisible)

- Belief
- Habit
- Pattern
- Foundation
- Environment
- Unseen decision

Most people only treat the surface.

This guide trains you to look underneath.

PART 4: REAL-WORLD EXAMPLES

HEALTH

Visible:

- Weight gain
- Low energy

Hidden possibilities:

- Eating patterns shaped by stress
 - Ignored body signals
 - Lifestyle rhythm misalignment
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FINANCES

Visible:

- Not enough money

Hidden possibilities:

- Spending habits
 - Emotional decision-making
 - Lack of structure in stewardship
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RELATIONSHIPS

Visible:

- Repeated conflict

Hidden possibilities:

- Unspoken expectations
 - Communication patterns
 - Past unresolved experiences influencing present reactions
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FAITH / SPIRITUAL LIFE

Visible:

- Confusion or distance

Hidden possibilities:

- Misunderstanding of Scripture
 - Identity confusion
 - Disconnection from truth patterns
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PART 5: THE 7-DAY FIELD PRACTICE

Each day, focus on ONE area of life.

Day 1 – Identify repetition

What keeps showing up?

Day 2 – Track the pattern

When did it start?

Day 3 – Observe your reaction

What do you do automatically?

Day 4 – Identify assumptions

What do you assume is “normal”?

Day 5 – Look for ignored signals

What warning signs were present early?

Day 6 – Name a possible root cause

Don’t force certainty—just identify possibility.

Day 7 – Choose ONE adjustment

Small correction, not overhaul.

PART 6: FENCEPOST WORKSHEET

Fill this in honestly:

The repeated issue I am seeing is:

The pattern I notice is:

What I usually blame is:

What I may not be seeing is:

One possible root cause could be:

One small correction I will try is:

PART 7: THE SHIFT

When you begin using this consistently, something changes:

You stop living in reaction.

You start living in observation.

And observation leads to wisdom.

FINAL THOUGHT

Most people spend their lives repairing broken rails.

Few ever look at the post holding everything up.

This guide is about becoming someone who finally looks deeper.

NEXT STEP

If this way of thinking helps you, you can continue learning through:

- Aloha Wellness (health and body design principles)
- Kingdom teachings (biblical understanding)
- Kingdom Wealth resources (stewardship principles)
- Ke Aupuni O Ke Akua Partner Support